

Wazuh Active Response Incident Report

Findings

Wazuh detected multiple failed SSH authentication attempts from the **sahib-windows** attacker host against the **sahib-linux** target host.

The activity triggered **Wazuh Rule ID 10002** with an **alert level of 10**.

Wazuh Active Response automatically blocked the attacker source after the detection threshold was reached.

Classification: True Positive — Simulated SSH Brute-Force Attack

Investigation Summary

A simulated SSH brute-force attack was performed from the **sahib-windows** attacker machine against the **sahib-linux** Linux endpoint as part of the Wazuh SOC home lab.

Multiple unsuccessful SSH authentication attempts were detected. Wazuh analyzed the authentication events and generated an alert using **Rule ID 10002, Level 10**.

The configured Active Response automatically blocked the attacker source, demonstrating automated detection and containment.

Detection → Alert → Active Response → Containment

Who, What, Where, Why, How

Who

- **Source/Attacker:** sahib-windows
- **Source IP:** ***
- **Target Host:** sahib-linux
- **Target IP:** ***
- **Targeted User:** sahib
- **Other Relevant Entity:** N/A

What

Multiple failed SSH authentication attempts were detected against the **sahib-linux** endpoint.

Wazuh identified the activity as brute-force behavior and generated a **Level 10 alert using Rule ID 10002**.

The configured Active Response subsequently blocked the attacker source.

Where

- **Target Host:** sahib-linux
- **Target IP:** ***
- **Operating System:** Linux
- **Service:** SSH
- **Port:** 22
- **Wazuh Agent:** sahib-linux
- **Source/Attacker Host:** sahib-windows
- **Source IP:** ***

Why

The activity was intentionally generated to test the Wazuh Active Response configuration in the SOC home lab.

The objective of the simulation was to verify that Wazuh could detect repeated SSH authentication failures and automatically respond by blocking the attacker source.

How

The **sahib-windows** attacker machine generated multiple unsuccessful SSH authentication attempts against the **sahib-linux** server.

The activity followed this workflow:

SSH Brute-Force Attempts → Linux Authentication Logs → Wazuh Agent → Wazuh Manager → Rule 10002 → Level 10 Alert → Active Response → Source Blocked

MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

- **Tactic:** Credential Access
 - **Technique:** Brute Force
 - **Technique ID:** T1110
 - **Sub-technique:** T1110.001 — Password Guessing
-

Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

Type	Indicator	Description
Source Host	sahib-windows	Simulated attacker machine
Source IP	***	Attacker source
Target Host	sahib-linux	Monitored Linux endpoint
Target IP	***	Target endpoint
Username	sahib	Targeted account
Service	SSH	Targeted service
Port	22	SSH service port

Wazuh Evidence

- **Wazuh Agent:** sahib-linux
- **Rule ID:** 10002
- **Alert Level:** 10
- **Log Source:** Linux SSH authentication logs
- **Event:** Multiple failed SSH authentication attempts
- **Active Response:** Automatic source blocking
- **Response Status:** Successfully executed

Evidence Collected

1. Screenshot showing failed SSH authentication attempts.
2. Screenshot showing the Wazuh Level 10 alert.
3. Screenshot showing Rule ID 10002.
4. Screenshot showing Active Response execution.
5. Screenshot showing the attacker source being blocked.
6. Screenshot showing a subsequent SSH connection attempt failing after the block.

Response Actions

- [x] SSH brute-force activity detected
- [x] Wazuh alert generated
- [x] Attacker source identified
- [x] Rule 10002 triggered
- [x] Level 10 alert generated
- [x] Active Response triggered
- [x] Attacker source blocked

- [x] Firewall block verified
 - [x] Post-response connection tested
-

Conclusion

Classification: True Positive — Simulated SSH Brute-Force Attack

Wazuh successfully detected repeated SSH authentication failures from **sahib-windows** against **sahib-linux**.

The activity triggered **Rule ID 10002 at Level 10**, after which Wazuh Active Response automatically blocked the attacker source.

The test successfully demonstrated an automated **detection, alerting, and containment** workflow within the Wazuh SOC home lab.

Recommendations

- Use strong passwords or SSH key-based authentication.
- Disable direct root SSH login where appropriate.
- Restrict SSH access using firewall rules or VPN access.
- Continue monitoring SSH authentication failures.
- Tune the brute-force detection threshold to minimize false positives.
- Regularly test Active Response to ensure automated containment works correctly.
- Document additional attack simulations and their corresponding Wazuh detections.